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Education

PhD in Economics, New York University, 2021-2027 (expected)
Fields: Macroeconomics, Housing
MA in Economics, Collegio Carlo Alberto (Allievi Program), 2018-2020
MSc in Economics, University of Turin, 2018-2020
BA in Economics, University of Trento, 2015-2018

References

Corina Boar
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Guido Menzio
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Sharon Traiberman
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Teaching Experience

Spring 2025, Fall 2025	Introduction to Econometrics, TA
Fall 2022, Fall 2024	Intermediate Macroeconomics, TA
Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2026, Fall 2026	International Economics, TA

Research Experience and Other Employment

2020-2021	European Central Bank, Trainee, Directorate General Statistics

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

2021-2027	NYU MacCracken Fellowship
2021	Unicredit Marco Fanno Scholarship
2018-2020	Carlo Alberto Allievi Honors Program
2015-2018	University of Trento Honors Program

Research Papers

Fertility and Housing Tenure Choice (Job Market Paper)

Housing costs are often blamed for low fertility, with proposed remedies ranging from easier mortgage credit to housing supply interventions. I study the potential for policies to raise fertility in a lifecycle model in which households choose whether and when to have children, how much space to occupy, and whether to rent or own. Children increase the need for a bigger house, buying requires a down payment, and earnings are subject to uninsurable idiosyncratic risk. I calibrate the model to the United States in 2007, estimate changes in fertility preferences to match the subsequent decline in birth rates, and treat 2023 as a point on a transition to a smaller population.

First, I show that earnings risk can substantially discourage childbirth: reducing the standard deviation of earnings shocks by about a quarter raises completed fertility by 16 percent, consistent with precautionary behavior and the commitment to ongoing spending on children. I then investigate how earnings risk interacts with housing costs and financial constraints. Starting from the 2023 economy, a 10 percent expansion of housing supply raises completed fertility by about 5 percent for the cohort entering adulthood, with persistent effects for later cohorts. Removing down-payment requirements produces an increase in births of about 2 percent on impact, but has little effect on completed fertility: it mostly affects the timing of births, and encourages ownership of small homes which potentially dissuade further natality. However, the same credit expansion restricted to parents raises completed fertility by about 6 percent. The results highlight the difference between helping households buy a home and helping them sustain the cost of the space children require.

Consumption Sorting and Inequality (with Saverio Spinella)

Households cluster in space by income and consumption. We study how spatial inequality shapes local retail prices. In our model, households invest time comparing prices across stores to spend less. A high concentration of retailers makes it easier to find better deals, while a high income reduces the incentive to search for bargains. Retailers respond to their customers' shopping behavior: rich neighborhoods attract more shops, especially those selling high-quality goods. Using NielsenIQ data, we document that households pay more for the same basket in richer neighborhoods, even conditional on their own income. Yet goods favored by richer households are relatively cheaper in richer locations. Retail markets thus respond to income and consumption segregation and sustain it. We use the calibrated model to compare affordability policies. Production subsidies are more progressive than price caps, but price caps are more effective at reducing segregation.

Research In Progress

Frictional Rental Markets and Inequality

Using ACS microdata, I document new facts on the heterogeneity of paid rents across individuals and cities. First, young people tend to pay higher rents and move more frequently, especially in denser and less housing-elastic cities. Second, recent movers—both within and across cities—pay systematically higher rents. These effects are heterogeneous across space and stronger in larger, denser metropolitan areas. To rationalize these patterns, I develop a parsimonious model of directed search in the rental market. The model explains the observed dispersion in paid rents and implies that increases in housing supply would disproportionately benefit younger and more mobile households.

Presentations

2026: DC Search & Matching Workshop*; SaM Annual Conference*; Symposium on Real Estate & Urban Policy — Indiana University/Chicago Fed.

NYU Macroeconomics Lunch; NYU Applied Microeconomics Student Lunch; NYU Stern Macro Lunch.

* Coauthor Presentation.